Persist Week of March 2, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday March 2, 2026
- Tuesday March 3, 2026
- Wednesday March 4, 2026
- Thursday March 5, 2026
- Friday March 6, 2026
- Saturday March 7, 2026
- Sunday March 8, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday March 2, 2026
- Tuesday March 3, 2026
- Wednesday March 4, 2026
- Thursday March 5, 2026
- Friday March 6, 2026
- Saturday March 7, 2026
- Sunday March 8, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday March 2, 2026
- Tuesday March 3, 2026
- Wednesday March 4, 2026
- Thursday March 5, 2026
- Friday March 6, 2026
- Saturday March 7, 2026
- Sunday March 8, 2026

- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday March 2, 2026
  - Tuesday March 3, 2026
  - Wednesday March 4, 2026
  - Thursday March 5, 2026
  - Friday March 6, 2026
  - Saturday March 7, 2026
  - Sunday March 8, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday March 2, 2026
  - Tuesday March 3, 2026
  - Wednesday March 4, 2026
  - Thursday March 5, 2026
  - Friday March 6, 2026
  - Saturday March 7, 2026
  - Sunday March 8, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday March 2, 2026
  - Tuesday March 3, 2026
  - Wednesday March 4, 2026
  - Thursday March 5, 2026
  - Friday March 6, 2026
  - Saturday March 7, 2026
  - Sunday March 8, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday March 2, 2026
  - Tuesday March 3, 2026
  - Wednesday March 4, 2026
  - Thursday March 5, 2026
  - Friday March 6, 2026
  - Saturday March 7, 2026
  - Sunday March 8, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday March 2, 2026
  - Tuesday March 3, 2026
  - Wednesday March 4, 2026
  - Thursday March 5, 2026

Friday March 6, 2026
Saturday March 7, 2026
Sunday March 8, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Isometric Bicep Blast
The finisher for today's training includes a curl, into a bicep-focused carry, into a farmer carry. The bicep has to work through this entire 8-minute AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible). You'll get small breaks by changing positions, but the total time under tension during this piece is very high. Even at light loads, this will lead to GAINZ!
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging Pull Ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60 sec
DB Bent Over Row; 10 @21X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.

F) Finisher (8 min):
8 min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
10 KB Horn Grip Bicep Curl
30m KB Horn Grip Carry
20m/side Single Arm KB Farmers Walk
*At the end of each side, perform 10 Single Arm Lean Away KB Shrug (same side of the carry).

Loading Note:

For the KB Curl, select a weight that you can perform for a max set of about 20 reps. For the farmers Walk, use a weight that you can perform for a max set of 100m.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Triceps - Open and Closed Chain
Open and closed chain movements are a subtle aspect of training - but they help train us to use our bodies more freely in different ways. A closed chain exercise means your limbs are connected to something stable - for example, in a Tricep Push Up, both arms push against the floor. On the other hand, in a DB Skullcrusher, your arms are connected to a dumbbell moving freely through space, making this open chain. As you move today, focus on the mind to muscle connection with both of these exercises.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets

Incline DB Chest Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Rolling Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Hands on Bench Narrow Grip Push Up; BW reps to failure (aiming for 10+ reps)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 4, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: B Stance Hip Thrust
This exercise needs your attention so that you don't compensate by using the bottom supporting leg or overarching the low back. Try to avoid these faults so you can keep the tension on the glutes. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Suitcase Front Foot Elevated KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (10-12 min):
2-3 sets
Frog Crunch; 10-15 reps
Cross Body Toe Touch; 10-20 reps (5-10/side)
Oblique Crunch; 10-15 reps/side

rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday March 5, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Supinated Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from previous weeks and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

F) Finisher (10-12 min):
2-3 sets
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Seated DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Plank Shoulder Taps; 30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday March 7, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Isolated Hip Muscles
The hip flexors and adductors are the rotator cuff of the lower body. Many people are familiar with different movements to help isolate and stabilize different areas of the shoulders. But they overlook similar ways to improve their hips. The isolation work in today's finisher is all about healthy hips.

Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for the first two moves. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Rower, Ring, or Physioball Hamstring Curl; 10-15 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Band Assisted Reverse Nordics; 8-12 reps @30X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the Hamstring Curl variation, use whichever implement you have access to or feels the best to you. Aim for each set to be challenging and feel good on the targeted areas (hamstrings/knees).

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Tuck L Hang or L Hang; 15-20 seconds
rest 15 sec
Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Fuel For Tomorrow

Most of us are short-sighted about nutrition. If the number on the scale is higher than we'd like, we immediately shrink our portions and step up the cardio - usually on the same day.

But our bodies adapt more gradually than that. And the energy you have today is more a result of what you did yesterday or even the day before.

Under-fueling on rest days or "lighter" days often shows up as poor sleep, low motivation, or flat workouts later in the week.

Carbohydrates, fluids, and electrolytes are tools. They help refill the tank so that training feels smoother instead of harder than it needs to be. Especially as training maturity increases, recovery nutrition becomes less about reward and more about readiness.

When Monday feels easier, it's often because Sunday was handled well.
What can you do today to fuel well for the days ahead?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Triceps - Open and Closed Chain

Open and closed chain movements are a subtle aspect of training - but they help train us to use our bodies more freely in different ways. A closed chain exercise means your limbs are connected to something stable - for example, in a Tricep Push Up, both arms push against the floor. On the other hand, in a DB Skullcrusher, your arms are connected to a dumbbell moving freely through space, making this open chain. As you move today, focus on the mind to muscle connection with both of these exercises.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

A) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

B) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES one you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 DB Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X0 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Incline DB Chest Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Rolling Skullcrusher; 15 reps @20X0
rest 30 sec
Hands on Bench Narrow Grip Push Up; BW reps to failure (aiming for 10+ reps)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: DB Positioning
Every time you change your dumbbell position for a squat or hinge, you impact the muscles that support the pelvis. Notice how these small position changes feel in your hips as you naturally brace to support each movement.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

A) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

B) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your Pull Ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging Pull Ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Tuck L Hang or L Hang; 15-20 seconds
rest 15 sec
Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Wednesday March 4, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it. Or try a 30/30 Cardio workout in the Additional Resources section of the app.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Thursday March 5, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Push up; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

B) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Supinated Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from previous weeks and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Seated DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Plank Shoulder Taps; 30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Daily Focus Notes: B Stance Hip Thrust
This exercise needs your attention so that you don't compensate by using the bottom supporting leg or overarching the low back. Try to avoid these faults so you can keep the tension on the glutes.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

A) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

B) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy

Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

C) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Suitcase Front Foot Elevated KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

E) Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Frog Crunch; 10-15 reps
Cross Body Toe Touch; 10-20 reps (5-10/side)
Oblique Crunch; 10-15 reps/side
rest 90 sec between sets

Loading Note:

*Minimal rest between exercises.

Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday March 7, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip External Rotation
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Fuel For Tomorrow

Most of us are short-sighted about nutrition. If the number on the scale is higher than we'd like, we immediately shrink our portions and step up the cardio - usually on the same day.

But our bodies adapt more gradually than that. And the energy you have today is more a result of what you did yesterday or even the day before.

Under-fueling on rest days or "lighter" days often shows up as poor sleep, low motivation, or flat workouts later in the week.

Carbohydrates, fluids, and electrolytes are tools. They help refill the tank so that training feels smoother instead of harder than it needs to be. Especially as training maturity increases, recovery nutrition becomes less about reward and more about readiness.

When Monday feels easier, it's often because Sunday was handled well.
What can you do today to fuel well for the days ahead?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance Superset
Today's superset is a combination of lower body exercises that are each manageable on their own. But when you combine them, they offer a strong, yet safe stimulus for the lower body.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side

Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
2-3 sets
Frog Crunch; 10-15 reps
Cross Body Toe Touch; 10-20 reps (5-10/side)
Oblique Crunch; 10-15 reps/side
rest 90 sec between sets
Loading Note:
*Minimal rest between exercises.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Wednesday March 4, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
B Stance Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The B Stance Hip Thrust places more load on one leg at a time allowing for isolation on each side. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1

rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from previous weeks and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Seated DB Rear Delt Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Plank Shoulder Taps; 30 sec
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday March 5, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip External Rotation
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side

Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Pullup EMOM
EMOM (Every Minute On the Minute) is a great way to accumulate more quality reps of Pull Ups. (Or every 75 seconds, as we will do today.) These can be very challenging to progress, especially if you're only doing the same number of sets every week. Today's Pull Up format focuses on completing more quality reps with a high number of sets and short to moderate rest times.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Supinated Strict Pull Up
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 8

Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:
As reps go down, make your pull-ups harder by adding weight or using less assistance. The goal of this session is to work on heavy/challenging pull ups. The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip or Ring Dip; 5-7 reps @32X1
rest 15 sec
Supinated Grip Ring Row; 10-20 reps @20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Perform a few dip warmup sets to determine weight. Aim for RPE 7-8 on the first working set and then keep the weight the same for the remainder.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Tuck L Hang or L Hang; 15-20 seconds
rest 15 sec
Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 10 reps

Saturday March 7, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):

30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Fuel For Tomorrow

Most of us are short-sighted about nutrition. If the number on the scale is higher than we'd like, we immediately shrink our portions and step up the cardio - usually on the same day.

But our bodies adapt more gradually than that. And the energy you have today is more a result of what you did yesterday or even the day before.

Under-fueling on rest days or "lighter" days often shows up as poor sleep, low motivation, or flat workouts later in the week.

Carbohydrates, fluids, and electrolytes are tools. They help refill the tank so that training feels smoother instead of harder than it needs to be. Especially as training maturity increases, recovery nutrition becomes less about reward and more about readiness.

When Monday feels easier, it's often because Sunday was handled well.
What can you do today to fuel well for the days ahead?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:

The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60 sec
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 3.2.1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.
Cluster Set - The "3.2.1" means do 3 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 2 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 1 rep. Use a similar weight or assistance as you would for a 5 rep max Pull Up.

E) Pull and Core Conditioning (15 min time cap):
2 Sets
For Time
1000/800m Bike (male/female)
-60sec rest-
4 rounds for time:
6 Right Arm KB Chainsaw Row 70/53# or 53/35#
6 Left Arm KB Chainsaw Row 70/53# or 53/35#
24 Mountain Climbers (12/side)
-60-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
Perform the first set at a sustainable pace. The second set should be close to consistent speed as the first set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Landmine Press
The landmine press is one of my favorite single arm pressing exercises. The stability of the landmine paired with the freedom to move it much like a dumbbell (freely) is quite unique. It encourages you to use this unique exercise to explore an angle with your pressing where you feel the strongest and most mind muscle connection to your shoulder muscles. There is no textbook look to this landmine press. You may press more off to the side of your shoulder, rotate your torso slightly, and really lean forward. Whatever gets you a great strength effort and pump is best.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Incline DB Chest Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6

DB Glute Bridge Floor Press
Feet Anchored Sit Up
*40m Farmers Walk between each round
Effort Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 4, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Training your calves is not just about looks, it is about balance around the knee. In this training session you are performing isolated calf work. This helps to target the muscles that directly support the area behind the knee. Straight leg variations of the calf raise in particular really strengthen the insertions behind the knee, which is essential for healthy strong knees. Of course, nicer calves are a bonus on top!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust; 12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
9 Dual KB Cleans 53/35# (male/female)
12 KB Sprawl
15-20 Cal Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday March 5, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Pushup; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps

Loading Note:

The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort (male/female)
10-15 Parallette Push-Ups
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort
6-8/side DB Chainsaw Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday March 7, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Wall Sit
A wall sit is intentionally challenging. This brief hold within the conditioning will make you dig deep to understand new levels of muscle contraction. Sometimes staying still is incredibly spicy. Bring your mental A Game!
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Split Stance Isometric Hold w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec

Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
rest 15 sec
10-12 Russian KBS 70/53# (male/female) or 53/35#
16 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (15/10#)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Fuel For Tomorrow

Most of us are short-sighted about nutrition. If the number on the scale is higher than we'd like, we immediately shrink our portions and step up the cardio - usually on the same day.

But our bodies adapt more gradually than that. And the energy you have today is more a result of what you did yesterday or even the day before.

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Carbohydrates, fluids, and electrolytes are tools. They help refill the tank so that training feels smoother instead of harder than it needs to be. Especially as training maturity increases, recovery nutrition becomes less about reward and more about readiness.

When Monday feels easier, it's often because Sunday was handled well.
What can you do today to fuel well for the days ahead?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Landmine Press
The landmine press is one of my favorite single arm pressing exercises. The stability of the landmine paired with the freedom to move it much like a dumbbell (freely) is quite unique. It encourages you to use this unique exercise to explore an angle with your pressing where you feel the strongest and most mind muscle connection to your shoulder muscles. There is no textbook look to this landmine press. You may press more off to the side of your shoulder, rotate your torso slightly, and really lean forward. Whatever gets you a great strength effort and pump is best.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6-8 reps @30X1
rest 30sec
Incline DB Chest Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30sec

Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
DB Glute Bridge Floor Press
Feet Anchored Sit Up
*40m Farmers Walk between each round
Effort Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
3) Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Wall Sit
A wall sit in the middle of today's conditioning is intentionally challenging. This brief hold will make you dig deep to understand new levels of muscle contraction. Sometimes staying still is incredibly spicy. Bring your mental A Game!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Split Stance Isometric Hold w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
rest 15 sec
10-12 Russian KBS 70/53# (male/female) or 53/35#
16 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (15/10#)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday March 4, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Thursday March 5, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Pushup; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps

Loading Note:

The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort (male/female)
10-15 Parallette Push-Ups
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort
6-8/side DB Chainsaw Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Today's strength balance focuses on finding balance in the lower body by training the muscles that support the knees and hips. Hip Thrusts and calves raises are great for building nicer calves and glutes, but also making the joints of the lower body feel good!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust; 12 reps @20X0

rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
9 Dual KB Cleans 53/35# (male/female)
12 KB Sprawl
15-20 Cal Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday March 7, 2026
Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right

6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip External Rotation
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Fuel For Tomorrow

Most of us are short-sighted about nutrition. If the number on the scale is higher than we'd like, we immediately shrink our portions and step up the cardio - usually on the same day.

But our bodies adapt more gradually than that. And the energy you have today is more a result of what you did yesterday or even the day before.

Under-fueling on rest days or "lighter" days often shows up as poor sleep, low motivation, or flat workouts later in the week.

Carbohydrates, fluids, and electrolytes are tools. They help refill the tank so that training feels smoother instead of harder than it needs to be. Especially as training maturity increases, recovery nutrition becomes less about reward and more about readiness.

When Monday feels easier, it's often because Sunday was handled well.
What can you do today to fuel well for the days ahead?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Pull Up Intention
On Pull Ups today, try to focus less on how many reps you are doing and more on the quality of those reps. To keep quality high, focus on initiating the pull with your lats, keeping your shoulder blades down and back, and reaching your chest towards the bar (not your chin). The tempo progression that is built in over the next four weeks will help you to continue to improve the quality of your Pull Ups.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6-8 reps @30X1

rest 30sec
Half Kneeling Landmine Press; 8 reps/side @20X0
rest 30sec
DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
rest 15 sec
10-12 Russian KBS 70/53# (male/female) or 53/35#
16 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (15/10#)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads

Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Wednesday March 4, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Push up; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort (male/female)
10-15 Parallette Push-Ups
Move immediately into the next couplet -
Every 2mins x 3 Sets
12/9 Bike Calories @ high effort
6-8/side DB Chainsaw Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to have the work completed around the 1min mark, giving you 1 full minute to rest on each set. If you find your work is taking you significantly longer than 1 minute, then reduce the calories or reps on either movement.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday March 5, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Hip External Rotation
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Full Body Conditioning
The conditioning for today's training involves elements of the four primary movement patterns: hinge, squat, push, pull. See if you can identify each one - remember that each exercise may express multiple movement patterns.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
3 Sets @ high effort
9 Dual KB Cleans 53/35# (male/female)
12 KB Sprawl
15-20 Cal Row
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 10 reps

Saturday March 7, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort

30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

Fuel For Tomorrow

Most of us are short-sighted about nutrition. If the number on the scale is higher than we'd like, we immediately shrink our portions and step up the cardio - usually on the same day.

But our bodies adapt more gradually than that. And the energy you have today is more a result of what you did yesterday or even the day before.

Under-fueling on rest days or "lighter" days often shows up as poor sleep, low motivation, or flat workouts later in the week.

Carbohydrates, fluids, and electrolytes are tools. They help refill the tank so that training feels smoother instead of harder than it needs to be. Especially as training maturity increases, recovery nutrition becomes less about reward and more about readiness.

When Monday feels easier, it's often because Sunday was handled well.
What can you do today to fuel well for the days ahead?

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Split Stance Deadlift Technique
First, set up in a position with the majority of your weight on the front leg (using your back leg to help balance). As you start to hinge, shift your entire bodyweight into the hip of the front leg. When you lower the bar, lead with your glutes, not your upper back.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) HOT START (10-12 minutes):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
18/15 Calorie Row (male/female)
8 Dual KB Snatch 35/26#
30 sec Dual KB Rack Pulse Squat 35/26#
rest 45 sec between rounds
Effort Note:
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Split Stance Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Frog Pump; 20-30 reps @10X0
rest 60 sec
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 3.2.1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.
Cluster Set - The "3.2.1" means do 3 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 2 reps, rest 10-15 sec, then 1 rep. Use a similar weight or assistance as you would for a 5 rep max pull up.

F) Pull Conditioning (12-15 min):
2 Sets
For Time
1000/800m Bike (male/female)
-60sec rest-
3 rounds for time:
4 Bar Muscle Up
6 Power Snatch (95/75)
36 Double Unders
-60-second rest and then repeat from the beginning for a second set-
Effort Note:
Perform the first set at a sustainable pace. The second set should be close to consistent speed as the first set.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pike Stretch; 30-60 sec
Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Dynamic Pigeon on Hands and Knees; 3 reps/side with 5 sec stretch.

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Landmine Press
The landmine press is one of my favorite single arm pressing exercises. The stability of the landmine paired with the freedom to move it much like a dumbbell (freely) is quite unique. It encourages you to explore an angle with your pressing where you feel the strongest and most mind muscle connection to your shoulder muscles. There is no textbook look to this landmine press. You may press more off to the side of your shoulder, rotate your torso slightly, and really lean forward. Whatever gets you a great strength effort and pump is best.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
Supinated Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Dip + Core + Shoulder Prefatigue (12 min):
3 Working Sets
Elevator Bar or Ring Dip; 4-6 reps
directly into
Dip Support Knee Tucks; 10-15 reps
rest 15sec
DB External Rotation on Knee; 12-15 reps/side
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Increase intensity each set. Start on the lower end of the reps (with less weight on the DB) and then increase weight and reps.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Half Kneeling Landmine Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Incline DB Chest Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Upper Body Conditioning (12 min):
12 min AMRAP @80-85% effort (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
4-6-8-10...(add 2 reps each round)
Alternating DB Power Clean (50/35#) (male/female)
Push Up
*8/6 Cal Bike between each set.
Effort Note:
Pace both movements from the start. The first few rounds will feel easy, but the intensity will pick up quickly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Banded Single Arm Lat Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shoulder Extension Bridge; 5-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 4, 2026
Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Today's strength balance focuses on finding balance in the lower body by training the muscles that support the knees and hips. Hip Thrusts and calves raises are great for building nicer calves and glutes, but also making the joints of the lower body feel good!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Goblet Cossack Squat; 5 reps/side
Standing Band Hip Abduction; 10-12 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
1 Pause at Knee Snatch Pull + 1 Pause at Knee Snatch + 1 Power Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets

Barbell Hip Thrust; 12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

F) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
Wall Sit; 60 sec
16 Dual KB Rack Box Step Up (35/26) (20"/16") (8/side)
16 Toes to Bar
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Thursday March 5, 2026
Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk

x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads
Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Pushup; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Gymnastics HOT START (10-12 min):
Every 3:00 x 4-5 sets
12/10 Cal Bike @ HIGH Effort (male/female)
3 Rope Climbs or 12 Strict Pull Ups

5 Strict HSPU or 5 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up
7 Kipping HSPU or 7 Yoga Push Ups
Effort Note:
Adjust pace as needed to prioritize high quality reps on the gymnastics movements.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 9 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 20X1 - Harder
Working Set 1 - 3 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 6 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 9 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Inverted Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

F) GRINDER Conditioning (12 min):
For Time @ Sustainable Pace
250/200m Row
50m Dual KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
8 Half Kneeling KB Windmill/arm 53/35# or 35/26#
250/200m Row
8 Half Kneeling KB Windmill/arm 53/35# or 35/26#
50m Dual KB Rack Carry 53/35# or 35/26#

250/200m Row
*Time Cap - 12mins
Effort Note:
These conditioning pieces are exploring challenging KB weights and movements like the GetUp and the Windmill over this 6-week cycle. Move at a controlled pace and slow down to make sure you execute the more complex movements correctly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday March 7, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Wall Sit
A wall sit in the middle of today's conditioning is intentionally challenging. This brief hold will make you dig deep to understand new levels of muscle contraction. Sometimes staying still is incredibly spicy. Bring your mental A Game!
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Weight Plate Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
5 sets; rest 90 sec between sets
1 Clean Pull + 1 Low Hang Clean Pull + 1 Low Hang Clean

Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunge; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Split Stance Isometric Hold w/ Pulse; 20-30 sec/side
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Alphabet Soup (20-25 minutes):
4 Sets:
A. 16 DB Deadlifts 50/35# (male/female)
B. 8 DB Burpee Box Step Up 50/35# (20/16" box)
C. 16-20 Cal Bike
D. 8 Renegade Rows
E. 16 DB Front Squats 50/35#
rest walk 2mins
Effort note:
Changing the exercise order each set requires good pacing and a better understanding of the demands of each individual movement. Follow this order:
Set 1 - ABCDE
Set 2 - EDCBA
Set 3 - CDEAB
Set 4 - BAEDC

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps
Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Fuel For Tomorrow

Most of us are short-sighted about nutrition. If the number on the scale is higher than we'd like, we immediately shrink our portions and step up the cardio - usually on the same day.

But our bodies adapt more gradually than that. And the energy you have today is more a result of what you did yesterday or even the day before.

Under-fueling on rest days or "lighter" days often shows up as poor sleep, low motivation, or flat workouts later in the week.

Carbohydrates, fluids, and electrolytes are tools. They help refill the tank so that training feels smoother instead of harder than it needs to be. Especially as training maturity increases, recovery nutrition becomes less about reward and more about readiness.

When Monday feels easier, it's often because Sunday was handled well.
What can you do today to fuel well for the days ahead?

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday March 2, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Half Kneeling DB Press
The kneeling press is one of my favorite single arm pressing exercises. The stability of the half kneeling position paired with the freedom to move the dumbbell in the plane and grip that works best for you sets this apart. I encourage you to explore a DB position angle with your pressing where you feel the strongest and most mind muscle connection to your shoulder muscles. There is no textbook look to this press. You may press more off to the side of your shoulder, in front of the shoulder, rotate your hand position with the dumbbell, or rotate your torso slightly. Whatever gets you a great strength effort and pump is best.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Turkish Get Up; 3 reps/side
Prone Half Angels; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Half Kneeling DB Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 6-8 reps @30X1
rest 30sec
Incline DB Chest Fly; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 30sec
Chest Supported DB Front Raise; 8-10 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
15-12-10-8-6
DB Glute Bridge Floor Press
Feet Anchored Sit Up
*40m Farmers Walk between each round
Effort Note:
Select a weight that you can perform for multiple sets of 15 reps.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Tuesday March 3, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Wall Sit
A wall sit in the middle of today's conditioning is intentionally challenging. This brief hold will make you dig deep to understand new levels of muscle contraction. Sometimes staying still is incredibly spicy. Bring your mental A Game!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Crush Grip Rotational Deadlift; 5 reps/side
Bird Dog Row; 5-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Split Stance Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The goal of the split stance deadlift is to develop single-leg strength in the hinge pattern. Be mindful of your weight selection because although you will be pushing with primarily one leg at a time, the lower back will have to be able to tolerate all reps. The rep scheme is structured for an increase in weight each set. The reps have decreased slightly from Week 2 allowing for an increase in weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Front Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Reverse Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0

rest 30 sec
Wall Sit; 45-60 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
3-4 Sets
Run 200m
rest 15sec
Wall Sit; 40-60 sec
rest 15 sec
10-12 DB Power Clean 50/35# or 35/20#
16 Weighted Hanging Knee Tuck (15/10#)
rest 15sec
Run 200m
rest walk 60-90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Set 1 - Moderate Pace
Set 2 - Hard Pace
Set 3-4 - Tough Pace

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Reclining Hero Pose; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Butterfly Stretch; 30 sec

Wednesday March 4, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip Flexors and Quads

Heel Sit x 1 min
Heel Sits x 10 reps
Reclining Hero Pose x 1-2 min
Half Kneeling Anterior Line Stretch x 1 min/side
Front Split x 1 min/side
Bottom of Squat Hold x 1 min

Thursday March 5, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Floor Press Progression
The reps and sets for the Floor Press progression will stay the same for the whole training block. This is intentional, since the rep scheme is a unique one. This pyramid rep scheme is one of the best for building muscle and strength simultaneously.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Plyo Push Up; 5 reps
Bulgarian Ring Row; 10-12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Floor Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 12 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8-9
Working Set 2 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 10 @ 20X1
Working Set 3 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform 12 @ 20X1
Working Set 4 - Reduce weight from last set by 5-10% and perform MAX reps
Loading Note:
The rep scheme is written as a full pyramid when including the warmup sets. Each set should be challenging, aiming for RPE 8-9. Working Set 1 should increase your potential to execute even better on working sets 2-4. Aim for a 5-10% decrease in weight with each set. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
DB Skull Crushers; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 30 sec
Hammer Curls; 6-8 reps @31X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 1 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
2 Shuttle Run
8-12 Ring Push-Up or Dumbbell Deficit Push Up
2 Shuttle Run
8 Right Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20# (male/female)
8 Left Arm DB Muscle Snatch 50/35# or 35/20#
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Pole Rhomboid Stretch; 30 sec
Straight Arm Shoulder Rotations; 10 reps/side
Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side

Friday March 6, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Strength Balance
Today's strength balance focuses on finding balance in the lower body by training the muscles that support the knees and hips. Hip Thrusts and calves raises are great for building nicer calves and glutes, but also making the joints of the lower body feel good!
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Reverse Lunge with Twist; 6 reps/side
Seated DB Goodmorning; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Goblet Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

Control the first descent, come up 1/4 of the way, then control back down into the bottom using a subtle bounce to accelerate all the way back to the top. The reps have decreased from Week 2, allowing for an increase in weight. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Hip Thrust; 12 reps @20X0
rest 30-60 sec
Hand Support Suitcase Calf Raise; 15-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
6 DB Burpee 50/35# (male/female)
8 DB Squat Cleans 50/35# (male/female)
10 Jump Lunge (5/side)
12 Sprawl
rest 60sec between sets
Effort Note:
The suggested loads are only here as a reference point. I want you to be able to move smoothly through all your weight reps without having to take breaks or slow down. If that means you need to lighten up your weight, then please do so.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Heel Sits; 10 reps

Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday March 7, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 75% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
30 sec Glute Bridge March
15 Tuck Ups
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 80% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets
Then 2-3 Sets for Quality
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Right
6 Reverse Lunge to High Knee Left
20m Quadruped Crawl Reverse
Then 30 sec Run, Bike, Ski, or Row @ 85% effort
30 sec Walk
x 10 sets

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Hip External Rotation
Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 2 min
Supine Figure 4 Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox ER Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER x 5-10 reps/side
Elevated Pigeon Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Sidelying Active Hip ER x 5 reps/side

Sunday March 8, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

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Marcus